

What Appeal Desk does with your data, stated plainly

Including what it does not do yet.

This sheet is written for compliance and operations reviewers. It describes the current version. Where something is planned rather than built, it says so.

Principles

- **The software never decides.** It prepares drafts. It cannot approve, deny or submit anything.
- **A named person is accountable.** Every approval, escalation or discard is recorded against a reviewer name, including whether the reviewer edited the draft.
- **Send less.** When AI drafting is used, only de-identified letter text is sent to the AI model.

What is removed before text goes to an AI model

Removed	Not removed
Values on labelled lines: patient name, member or subscriber ID, date of birth Social Security number formats Phone numbers Email addresses	Names or details written inside sentences Street addresses Free-text clinical details Anything in an unusual layout that the patterns do not recognise

Removed values are replaced with tokens such as [PATIENT_NAME]. The originals stay on the machine running the tool and are put back into the draft locally. If no labelled patient name is found in a letter, the tool **does not send that letter to the AI at all**, shows a red warning, and drafts from a built-in template instead.

In this configuration, de-identified text is sent to Anthropic's Claude API. Please review the provider's data terms with your compliance team.

What is stored, and where

Item	Detail
Case files	Extracted claim details and the draft or approved letter, as files on the machine running the tool.
Audit log	Reviewer names, timestamps, decisions, fingerprints (hashes) of the letter and the draft, counts of identifiers removed, warnings raised, and any note the reviewer types.
Location	A machine you control, or a machine we operate for the pilot under an agreed arrangement. No shared cloud database.

The audit trail

Each entry is fingerprinted with SHA-256, and the fingerprint includes the previous entry's fingerprint. Editing or deleting an old entry breaks the chain, and the tool shows exactly where. This makes after-the-fact changes

to individual entries detectable.

Limit: the chain does not by itself stop someone with full access to the machine from rebuilding the whole file. Anchoring the latest fingerprint in a separate location is planned.

Known limitations of the current version

Area	Today
De-identification	Pattern-based. It is a safeguard, not a guarantee.
Access control	No user accounts or roles. Access is whatever access exists to the machine.
Encryption at rest	Not implemented. Files rely on disk-level protection of the host machine.
Input formats	Letter text. PDF and scan intake are not yet built.
Certification	Not HIPAA-certified, and not independently audited. HIPAA obligations depend on your role and contracts.

Recommended for any pilot. Use redacted or synthetic letters only until a written agreement (NDA, and a business associate agreement where relevant, reviewed by your counsel) is in place and the limitations above are acceptable for your use.

Planned, not yet built

- PDF and scanned-letter intake
- User accounts and roles
- Encryption at rest
- Anchoring the audit fingerprint outside the machine
- An independent security review